

Facing eviction from bungalows they have lived in for decades following a Supreme Court order, smaller parties in search of a new home in Delhi could find a chic address hard to come by as the Congress splits the cake in its favour

■ By Shafi Rahman

When it comes to splitting up the family silver, the nation's politicians are beginning to resemble eternally fractious Indian families. As the Government doles out plots to political parties for the construction of their future headquarters, some are turning green with envy as bigger parties get their hands on posh properties while they are being given down-market addresses. The Ministry of Urban Development is disbursing these plots following a Supreme Court order to evict parties from the heritage sites in the capital they have been squatting in for many years.

It was meant to be an act in good governance, but the allotment spree has produced a windfall for many parties, especially the ruling Congress. In the capital, where the real estate business is often a blood sport, land is being lavishly bestowed upon a fortunate few. As the land will be disbursed according to a party's combined strength in the two

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